



The Pocket Penguin A Customised Linux-In-Your-Pocket!

Let's imagine you're spending a weekend at your cousin's home. You suddenly feel like working on your Web project. You ask your cousin's permission to use his computer. Unfortunately, you realise that the installed OS, Windows, lacks your favourite programs, tools and reference material! So how do you work? In times like this, a live-Linux USB flash drive can rescue you!

*I*magine, you can just plug in your USB drive, and boot into your favourite desktop environment—with all your vital programs like HTML editors and Web browsers customised for debugging; with all your project files and reference material ready and waiting for you. And you even have your favourite wallpaper on display! This is the concept behind Pocket Linux, which lets you back up your entire system onto your pen drive. You can store network configurations, bookmarks, wallpapers, theme settings, your 'must-have' programs, and even other files that you need (including that Jimi Hendrix album that you can't live without!).

Let me take you through my experience of creating a Lucid Linux bootable USB flash drive, which I use when I am on the move (it's easier than carrying a laptop), or as a fall-back option since I keep changing my laptop's OS from Ubuntu to Fedora to Frugalware, and anything else that's new.

Persistence file

So what is it that turns your flash drive into a portable hard disk with an OS installed? Well, it is the persistence file that stores your personal settings and installed programs on your flash drive. Ubuntu documentation of the live CD feature states that the use of a persistence image has a clear advantage over cloud computing, as it